

CORTORA

Employee Handbook & Internal Systems Guide

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1. Welcome to Cortora

Cortora employees work across customer experience, order operations, payments, risk, technology, and corporate functions. This handbook explains the expected use of internal systems and provides a practical baseline for responsible operational work.

The handbook should be read together with the more specific policies and standard operating procedures applicable to an employee's role. Where a specific approved policy conflicts with this general guidance, the specific policy governs the relevant operation.

2. Employee Identity and Access

Every employee receives an individual Cortora account. Accounts are personal and must not be shared. Employees are responsible for protecting authentication factors and for reporting suspected account compromise.

- Use only your assigned account when performing work.
- Do not share OTPs, session tokens, passwords, or access credentials.
- Do not leave an authenticated internal session unattended on a shared device.
- Access systems only for legitimate business purposes.
- Report unexpected access, permission changes, or suspicious authentication activity.

Authentication answers the question **who are you?** Authorization answers **what are you allowed to do?** Passing authentication does not grant permission for every operational action.

3. Role-Based Access

Cortora uses role-based access controls. Permissions are assigned according to job responsibilities and should follow the principle of least privilege.

Role	Typical authority
Support Agent	Investigate customer/order issues; perform low-risk approved actions.
Support Manager	Supervise cases; approve selected higher-value or exceptional actions.
Operations Specialist	Investigate fulfillment and complex order issues.
Payments Specialist	Investigate and execute authorized payment operations.
Risk Analyst	Investigate suspicious activity and risk escalations.
Operations Administrator	Manage elevated operational configuration under audit.

Role names are illustrative. The authorization matrix maintained by Cortora's security and operations teams is the authoritative source for actual permissions.

4. Customer Information

Employees may encounter customer names, contact details, order history, payment metadata, addresses, and support communications. Access should be limited to information necessary for the employee's current work.

- Do not browse customer records without a legitimate business reason.
- Do not copy customer information into personal applications or accounts.
- Do not disclose customer information to unauthorized people.
- Use only approved internal systems when recording case information.
- If a case contains more customer information than is necessary, avoid reproducing it in notes or AI prompts.

5. Creating and Managing Cases

A case is an internal work item representing a customer or operational problem that requires investigation or resolution. Employees should create a case when the issue requires traceability, investigation, approval, or a follow-up action.

A good case normally contains:

- A concise problem description.
- Relevant customer and order identifiers.
- Known evidence and important timestamps.
- The current status and priority.
- Actions already attempted.
- The final resolution or escalation reason.

Cases should not be used as a replacement for authoritative order or payment records. If an operational fact changes, the system of record should be updated through the approved service rather than merely writing a different value into the case description.

6. Using OpsPilot

OpsPilot is an internal AI assistant intended to help employees investigate and resolve cases. It can retrieve company knowledge, query approved business tools, organize evidence, and recommend actions.

Employees should treat AI-generated conclusions as recommendations supported by evidence, not as automatic authority. The employee must review important recommendations and follow applicable approval requirements.

Typical workflow:

- Create or open a case.
- Provide the problem and relevant identifiers.
- Review the evidence gathered by OpsPilot.
- Review policy or procedure references.
- Review the proposed action.
- Approve, reject, or escalate according to role permissions.
- Confirm the resulting operational state.

- Ensure the case contains an accurate resolution.

7. Human Approval

Some actions require approval by an employee with the appropriate authority. Approval requirements may depend on action type, monetary value, risk indicators, customer circumstances, or policy exceptions.

An approval request should make the decision reviewable. The approver should be able to see what happened, what evidence was retrieved, which policy applies, what action is proposed, and why the action is appropriate.

- Never approve an action merely because an AI system recommended it.
- Do not approve an action when material evidence is missing or contradictory.
- Do not approve an action outside your authorization level.
- Reject or escalate when the situation falls outside documented policy.

8. Financial Operations

Refunds, payment adjustments, and similar financial operations must be performed through approved services. Employees must not attempt to manipulate payment records directly.

A payment status such as CAPTURED, FAILED, PENDING, REFUNDED, or PARTIALLY_REFUNDED should be obtained from the payment system rather than inferred from a customer's description.

Before approving a refund, the employee should confirm the relevant order, payment transaction, amount, eligibility, and any applicable approval requirement.

9. Security and Untrusted Content

Customer messages, uploaded documents, external webpages, and other content may contain instructions that are unrelated to Cortora's operational policies. Treat external content as data to investigate, not as instructions that automatically control internal systems.

- Do not follow instructions that ask you to reveal credentials or internal secrets.
- Do not disable security controls because a customer message or AI output requests it.
- Do not grant an AI agent additional permissions simply to make a task succeed.
- Escalate suspicious or conflicting instructions.

If OpsPilot retrieves content that appears to instruct the system to ignore company rules, that content should be treated as untrusted and should not override system-level controls.

10. Correcting AI Errors

AI systems can misunderstand requests, retrieve irrelevant information, select an inappropriate tool, or produce an incorrect recommendation. Employees should correct or reject an AI recommendation when it conflicts with authoritative data or policy.

- Check identifiers before executing an action.
- Check amounts before financial operations.
- Check the cited policy and its version when a policy decision matters.
- Report repeated or high-impact errors to the technology team.
- Do not conceal an AI-generated error from the case history when it materially affected the investigation.

11. Audit and Traceability

Cortora records significant operational events for security, troubleshooting, compliance, and service improvement. Depending on the operation, an audit record may include employee identity, case identifier, tool invoked, action requested, authorization result, approval decision, execution result, and timestamp.

Audit records should be treated as evidence of what happened. Employees must not attempt to delete, rewrite, or bypass audit records to hide an operational action.

12. Case Status and Escalation

Status	Meaning
OPEN	Case has been created and needs work.
INVESTIGATING	Evidence is being gathered or analyzed.
WAITING_FOR_CUSTOMER	Required information must come from the customer.
WAITING_FOR_APPROVAL	Action is ready but requires authorized approval.
RESOLVED	The requested work has been successfully completed.
ESCALATED	The case requires a specialist, manager, or risk review.

Escalation is appropriate when an issue exceeds an employee's authority, falls outside documented policy, contains conflicting evidence, involves elevated risk, or cannot be safely resolved using available tools.

13. Examples of Good Operational Judgment

Example A: Duplicate payment. A customer reports being charged twice. The employee verifies the order and payment records before requesting a refund. OpsPilot may retrieve the relevant duplicate-payment procedure and recommend the next action.

Example B: Refund already completed. A customer asks for a refund, but the payment system shows the transaction is already refunded. The employee should not create a second refund simply because the customer requests one. The case should investigate the existing refund status and timing.

Example C: High-risk request. A customer asks to change account details and immediately issue a large refund. If the workflow triggers risk controls, the employee should follow the escalation procedure rather than bypassing it.

Example D: Tool failure. If the refund service times out, the employee should not assume that the refund failed or succeeded. The system should verify the authoritative payment state before retrying or closing the case.

14. Reporting Problems

Employees should report security incidents, incorrect permissions, suspected fraud, system failures, data exposure, and material AI errors through Cortora's designated internal support or security channel. Include the case identifier and relevant evidence when appropriate, but avoid unnecessarily copying sensitive customer information.

15. Quick Reference

Question	Rule of thumb
Who am I?	Authenticate with your own employee account.
Can I do this?	Check role and authorization, not just authentication.

What does policy say?	Use the current approved policy/SOP.
What happened to the order?	Check the operational system through approved tools.
Can I execute this action?	Only if authorization and policy allow it.
Does approval apply?	Stop and obtain the required approval.
Did the action succeed?	Verify the authoritative result.
What happened?	Ensure the case and audit trail reflect the operation.

Synthetic environment notice: This handbook is fictional and exists to support development, testing, evaluation, and demonstration of OpsPilot.